Employees Deposit Linked Insurance Scheme (EDLI). The corpus of funds managed by EPFO at the end of financial year 2019–20 thus exceeded 12.70 lakh crore. In addition, the corpus of exempted funds was Rs 83,640 crore at end 2019–20. The New Pension Scheme (NPS) had Rs 6.57 lakh crore of assets under management at the end of October 2021. These three long-term/retirement savings organizations had over Rs 40 lakh crore of assets under management at the end of financial year 2018–19. Currently, their assets under management exceed Rs 55 lakh crore.

EPFO had 13.50 lakh contributing establishments, 23.43 crore contributing members and 66.83 lakh pensioners as on 31 March 2020. NPS had 140.10 lakh contributing subscribers at the end of October 2021. And LIC had 27.97 crore policies in force at the end of financial year 2020–21.

All the three behemoths invest primarily in government securities. Regulatory policies prescribe the investment pattern and these organizations have very little leeway in managing their investments. While LIC uses its inhouse investment management capability, both EPFO and NPS have virtually given their investment corpus to fund managers who abide by the regulatory policies prescribed for investments.

Investment guidelines for EPFO are focused on government securities. A minimum of 45 per cent and up to 65 per cent of the corpus is required to be invested in government securities, other securities guaranteed by the government and units of MFs investing in government securities. As on 31 March 2020, EPFO had invested Rs 2.09 lakh crore in Central government securities, Rs 5.09 lakh crore in state government securities and Rs 2.16 lakh crore in securities of public sector financial institutions/undertakings. Further, Rs 0.54 lakh crore is lying in the Centre’s special deposit scheme. More than 60 per cent of the overall debt portfolio of EPFO is in government securities and deposits. It invests the remaining amount in PSU bonds and a little in private-sector companies’ bonds. The investment